

SPE

21 Rules of Engagement

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Why 21 Rules?



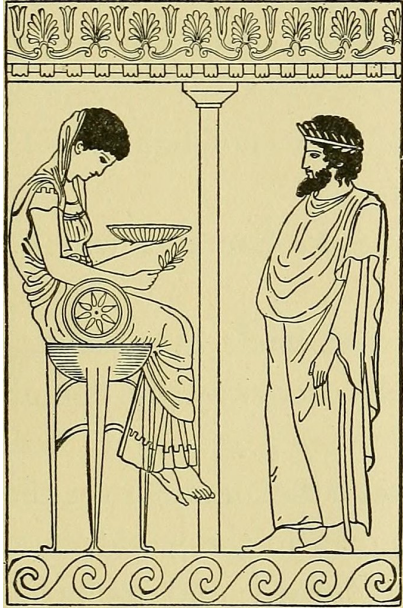
- For many projects are a first encounter with the “business” culture
- The clients are volunteering to work with us and can be shy
- We need to interact professionally and be mindful of their time and knowledge

Email

1. All emails to the client are sent by the group secretary, unless the group secretary is ill or for some other reason not able to do it
2. The group secretary copies in all team members and the mentor on every email.
3. All email addresses included in a received email are retained in all responses.
4. If the client removes email addresses from their organisation, they are not added back in in a response.
5. If the client removes email addresses from the team or the mentor, they are added back in in a response.
6. Unless you have a good reason to deviate, an email starts with "Dear <client first name>
7. Unless you have a good reason to deviate, an email ends with "Best regards\nFirst name"



What to ask Client



1. Anything related to marking or the organisation of the unit to be referred to your mentor, not client
2. Try to minimise communication with the client (batch requests into a "weekly" email if appropriate)
3. If you are unsure if you should be sharing something with your client - ask your mentor
4. Don't get your client to do work for you - if there is a task that you are able to do, don't just pass it on to your client

Meetings

1. When meetings with the clients are arranged, then calendar invites are sent out with Teams calls - unless the clients explicitly says that she would like to invite.
2. Meetings start on time and are aimed to finish 10 minutes early.
3. Never overrun a meeting without explicitly confirming that this is okay with everyone, especially the client.
4. All students turn on their cameras for meetings with the clients, unless there is a good reason not to.
5. All students participate in all team meetings unless they have a strong reason not to for a single occasion.
6. Send out an agenda prior to the meeting. This can be done as part of the calendar invite, or in a separate email the day before.
7. One student take notes as minutes and shares these with the client after the meeting.



Attitudes

1. Assume that the client does know not anything, except what they would like the software to do. In particular, the client does not know anything about the project run time, the semester, what frameworks to use, where to deploy software, etc.
2. Your job is to act as a filter and buffer between the client and the unit - only pass on information and requests that the client actually needs to know about (don't just forward messages/slides/web pages to then)
3. In every meeting attempt to understand the other side and what they value and find a solution that maximises the value for both sides